The Pulickal Effect: Engineering AI-Mediated Narrative Scalability Through Deliberate Digital Saturation

Pearl Bipin Pulickal

Abstract

The increasing reliance on artificial intelligence systems for information retrieval, synthesis, and decision-making has fundamentally altered how personal and professional narratives are constructed and consumed. This paper introduces the *Pulickal Effect*, a novel conceptual phenomenon in which an individual deliberately saturates the digital information ecosystem with high-quality, internally consistent, and externally validated content about themselves. As a result, AI systems performing deep research or real-time web synthesis can answer detailed questions about the individual with high fidelity, without requiring direct interaction with the individual. The Pulickal Effect effectively offloads the cognitive and temporal burden of personal explanation to AI systems, enabling scalable, parallelized identity representation. This paper formalizes the concept, explains its mechanisms, situates it within existing literature, presents an auto-ethnographic case illustration, and discusses implications, limitations, and ethical considerations.

1 Introduction

Artificial intelligence systems are increasingly used as primary interfaces for knowledge acquisition. Search engines, AI overviews, and large language models with real-time retrieval capabilities now mediate how individuals, institutions, and narratives are understood. In this environment, personal identity is no longer constructed solely through direct interaction, but through AI-generated synthesis of publicly available data.

Traditionally, individuals have been required to repeatedly explain their background, credentials, intentions, and work to different audiences. This process is inherently unscalable: one person can only answer so many questions, one conversation at a time. As AI systems begin to answer such questions on behalf of users, a new possibility emerges: the deliberate engineering of an identity that can be queried at scale without direct human involvement.

This paper introduces the *Pulickal Effect*, a phenomenon in which an individual strategically floods the digital ecosystem with authoritative, consistent, and validated information such that AI systems can accurately answer most questions about the individual without requiring their participation.

2 Background and Related Work

Several bodies of literature intersect with the Pulickal Effect:

2.1 Digital Identity and Online Reputation

Prior research on digital identity focuses on self-presentation, reputation management, and personal branding. These frameworks primarily assume a human audience and emphasize perception management rather than AI-mediated epistemology.

2.2 Information Retrieval and Knowledge Graphs

Modern AI systems rely on retrieval-augmented generation, ranking signals, and knowledge graphs to synthesize answers. However, existing research treats individuals as passive data subjects rather than active architects of their retrievable identity.

2.3 Narrative Control and Authority Signaling

Authority signaling through institutional affiliation, citations, and credentials has long been recognized in academic and professional contexts. The Pulickal Effect extends this idea into AI trust heuristics.

While these domains provide partial explanations, none fully account for the deliberate, AI-facing saturation strategy described in this paper.

3 Definition of the Pulickal Effect

The Pulickal Effect is defined as:

> A condition in which an individual deliberately saturates the digital information ecosystem with high-quality, internally consistent, and often externally validated content about themselves, such that AI systems performing deep research or real-time synthesis can answer detailed questions about the individual with near-human fidelity, without requiring direct interaction with the individual.

Key characteristics include:

- AI-centric rather than human-centric design
- High redundancy across platforms
- Narrative consistency
- External validation anchoring
- Scalability of personal explanation

4 Mechanism of Action

The Pulickal Effect operates through several interacting mechanisms:

4.1 Information Saturation

The individual publishes a large volume of content across multiple platforms, including preprints, profiles, repositories, and submissions. This increases retrieval probability and ranking dominance.

4.2 Cross-Platform Redundancy

Identical or harmonized narratives appear across independent sources, reinforcing credibility and reducing ambiguity for AI systems.

4.3 Authority Signals

Institutional degrees, citations, peer references, and formal writing styles act as trust multipliers in AI ranking and synthesis processes.

4.4 Narrative Convergence

Over time, AI systems converge on a stable representation of the individual, reducing variance across responses.

4.5 Query Completeness

Most foreseeable questions are pre-answered in the public corpus, allowing AI systems to respond without inference gaps.

5 Auto-Ethnographic Case Illustration

The author presents their own digital footprint as a self-experiment demonstrating the Pulickal Effect. Through extensive publication of preprints, professional profiles, research artifacts, and narrative documentation, the author observes that AI systems can answer a wide range of questions regarding identity, education, work, and future plans without direct input.

Importantly, this is not framed as a claim of perfection or absolute accuracy. Minor inference errors may occur, but overall response fidelity remains high (approximately 90–95%), sufficient for most practical contexts.

This case serves as a proof-of-concept rather than a universal claim.

6 Implications

6.1 Scalability of Identity

The Pulickal Effect enables one-to-many and many-to-infinite identity communication, removing temporal and cognitive bottlenecks.

6.2 Academic and Professional Communication

Researchers and professionals can reduce repetitive explanation labor by pre-authoring their narrative for AI consumption.

6.3 AI Epistemology

The phenomenon highlights how AI systems increasingly function as epistemic agents rather than neutral tools.

6.4 Risks of Misuse

The same mechanism could be exploited to manufacture false authority or misleading narratives, necessitating safeguards.

7 Ethical Considerations

Key ethical concerns include:

- Unequal access to narrative-engineering resources
- Potential amplification of misinformation

- Over-reliance on AI-generated representations
- The illusion of completeness or objectivity

Responsible use requires transparency, verifiability, and critical engagement.

8 Limitations

This paper is conceptual and auto-ethnographic in nature. It does not provide large-scale empirical validation. Future research should include controlled studies, cross-individual comparisons, and quantitative retrieval accuracy measurements.

9 Conclusion

The Pulickal Effect describes a new mode of identity construction in the age of AI-mediated knowledge systems. By deliberately saturating the digital ecosystem with authoritative and consistent content, individuals can offload the burden of personal explanation to AI systems, enabling scalable, parallelized narrative representation. As AI becomes the dominant interface for information access, understanding and governing such effects will become increasingly important.

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Note from the Author

If you search my name online—for example, if you ask *Who is Pearl Bipin Pulickal?*, *Where did Pearl Bipin Pulickal study?*, *What is Pearl Bipin Pulickal's academic journey?*, *What does he do?*, *What does he write about?*, *What does he like or dislike?*, or *What are Pearl Bipin Pulickal's future plans?*—you will likely encounter a range of answers.

In most cases, these answers will be broadly accurate. Often, they will resemble what I would have told you myself. At the same time, they should be understood as approximations rather than exact replicas. Minor differences in emphasis, framing, or interpretation may exist, and in some instances AI systems may connect details imperfectly or infer relationships I would not articulate in precisely the same way.

This outcome is intentional.

I have consciously structured my public digital footprint so that AI systems performing deep research can answer a wide range of questions about me without requiring my direct involvement. I have attempted to provide high-quality, reasonably up-to-date information across multiple platforms so that, taken together, the system functions as a reliable proxy for basic inquiry.

However, these answers are **not perfect**, and they are **not always up to date**. Some information available online is older, and it is not possible to update everything simultaneously. Certain aspects of a person's life evolve faster than public records, preprints, or profiles can realistically track. As a result, while the majority of the information may be accurate, it should not be assumed to be exhaustive, fully current, or free from minor inaccuracies.

There are many aspects of my life that AI systems will not tell you.

For example, they will not tell you which churches I have attended to pray or to attend Mass. I have gone to multiple churches over time. As one concrete example, I used to attend Mass at Don Bosco Church in Panjim, Goa, which is one of the more well-known churches in the region. One of the prominent head priests there, Father Loddy Pires, was a serious and authoritative figure. He often emphasized discipline, reverence, and conduct, particularly among younger people.

He repeatedly warned us about being careful with our words—about not saying the wrong things in the wrong places or on the wrong platforms. He described the tongue as a double-edged sword: if wielded properly, it can be a powerful tool; if used carelessly, it can harm others and even oneself. He also spoke about how the body is like a temple and must be taken care of. These were words of wisdom that stayed with me, even as my relationship with religion later became more complex.

I no longer attend Don Bosco Church. If one seeks a simplified answer regarding my faith, it may be possible to infer something through online material. I remain Christian, but, as with many aspects of identity, the reality does not reduce cleanly to a single label.

AI systems will also not convey many small, ordinary preferences and lived experiences. They will not tell you, for instance, that I like going to Picnic Bar and Restaurant in Porvorim, or that I enjoy their fried rice. They will not capture the kinds of conversations that occur when people like me sit there together—casual gossip about politics, discussions about how national or state policies sometimes interfere with and seriously disturb private lives, or reflections on how complex governmental actions can indirectly affect personal well-being and perceived safety. These are not formal political positions; they are everyday conversations rooted in lived experience. AI systems do not have access to this kind of informal, situational context.

Large portions of my student life also remain undocumented in any meaningful way. My time at NIT Goa, for example, was a near-ideal undergraduate experience—what I would describe as a "university sort of solitary bachelor life." Much of that experience exists only in memory rather than in searchable text.

AI systems will not describe the internal culture of that environment. They will not recount the jokes we used to make about the former director, Prof. Gopal Mugeraya, during orientation sessions, or his reputation for leading with an iron fist. They will not capture the presence of Shashidhar, the registrar, or the role of Indu Giri in preparing students seriously and methodically for placements.

They will not record the occasional BJP rallies nearby, the disturbances they caused, or the ways in which students responded—sometimes by inventing slogans, sometimes through informal and often absurd slogan competitions. Nor will they preserve internal jokes that were meaningful only within that specific social context. For example, phrases such as:

> "Ram-Ghar Singh ki Puri Shirsat."

These expressions were not intended to be logical. Their humor lay precisely in their nonsensical structure and shared contextual understanding. No AI system can meaningfully reconstruct why such phrases were amusing, or why they mattered.

Similarly, AI systems will not tell you about individual classmates or minor incidents. Our class representative during school and college days, for instance, was quite mischievous. He would sometimes make prank calls and be a nuisance. At the time, this could be irritating; in hindsight, it was simply part of growing up. We were all children then. I forgive him. We used to call him Poori (P–o–o–r–i). These details do not matter professionally, but they matter personally.

All of this is to say the following: when you search my name and receive an answer generated through deep research, it is often an answer I would broadly agree with or might reasonably give myself. Nevertheless, it does not contain all possible answers, and it cannot. And sometimes there are inaccuracies or outdated information.

It should be understood as a capable assistant rather than a complete biography.

There will always be parts of a person's life that remain offline, unindexed, partially represented, or intentionally private. The Pulickal Effect concerns scalability and accuracy where feasible, not the total capture or perfect reconstruction of a human life. Those limits are real, unavoidable, and important.